

SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital — Medical Records & Reports Guide

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1. Purpose & Scope

1.1 Purpose

This document establishes comprehensive guidelines governing the generation, retention, digital storage, patient access, release protocols, physical copy issuance, correction procedures, and privacy compliance for health records at SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital.

1.2 Scope

This policy applies to all outpatient consultation notes, diagnostic laboratory reports, radiology imaging files, surgical operative logs, nursing charts, inpatient discharge summaries, and medico-legal documentation maintained within the SmartCare Electronic Medical Record (EMR) system and physical archives.

2. Anatomy of a Hospital Medical Record

A complete medical record at SmartCare Hospital encompasses:

- **Demographic & Registration Data:** Legal Name, UHID, Date of Birth, Gender, Emergency Contact, and Consent Forms.
 - **Outpatient Consultation Notes:** Primary symptoms, clinical examination findings, vitals, provisional diagnosis, and doctor advice.
 - **Diagnostic Reports:** Laboratory biochemistry, hematology, microbiology cultures, and histopathology biopsy reports.
 - **Radiology & Imaging:** Formal radiologist reports and digital DICOM files for X-rays, Ultrasounds, CT scans, and MRIs.
 - **Inpatient Documentation:** Daily doctor progress notes, nursing medication charts, vital graphs, and multidisciplinary specialist cross-consultations.
 - **Surgical & Anesthetic Records:** Pre-anesthetic evaluation, informed surgical consents, surgical safety checklists, operative notes, and post-anesthesia recovery notes.
 - **Discharge Summaries:** Official discharge notes detailing admission reasons, treatments administered, procedures performed, hospital course, discharge vitals, and home medications.
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3. Digital Records & Patient Portal Access

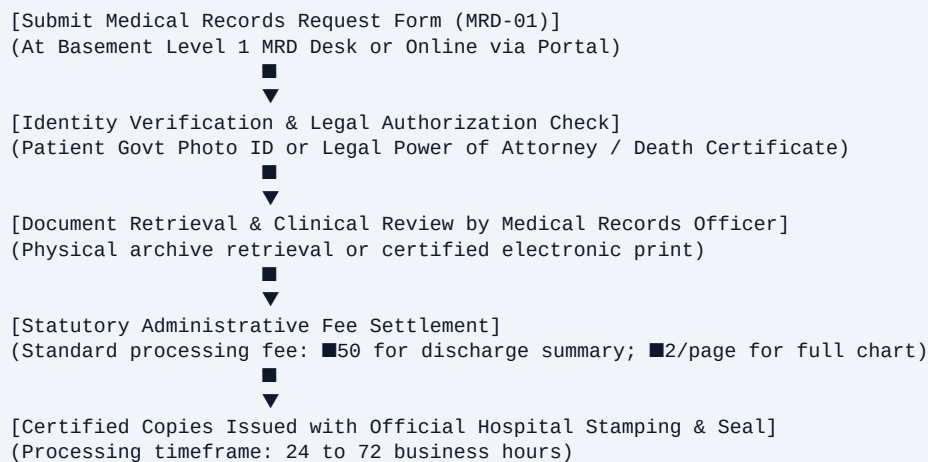
SmartCare Hospital provides immediate, secure 24/7 digital access to medical reports:

- 1. Access Channels:**
- **SmartCare Patient Mobile App** (available on iOS and Android).
 - **SmartCare Web Portal:** <https://www.smartcarehospital-demo.org/myhealth>.
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- **Automated WhatsApp Service:** Verified PDF download links sent to the patient's registered mobile number upon report authorization.
- 2. **Secure Authentication:** Digital access requires two-factor authentication (2FA) via the patient's Unique Hospital Identification (UHID) and a One-Time Password (OTP) sent to their registered mobile number.
- 3. **Turnaround for Digital Availability:**
 - Routine Blood / Urine Reports: Accessible within 2 to 4 hours of collection.
 - Routine X-Ray / CT / MRI Reports: Accessible within 4 to 8 hours of scan completion.
 - Inpatient Discharge Summaries: Accessible within 6 hours of final clinical discharge.

4. Requesting Physical Stamped Copies of Medical Records

Patients or authorized representatives requiring physical stamped copies for legal, insurance, travel, or external medical referral purposes must follow this standard operating procedure:



5. Legally Authorized Requesters

In strict accordance with national medical council regulations and privacy statutes, medical records are released exclusively to:

1. **The Competent Adult Patient:** Upon presentation of a valid Government photo ID.
2. **Legal Parents / Guardians:** In the case of minor patients (under 18 years of age).
3. **Designated Legal Proxy / Next-of-Kin:** If the patient is incapacitated, upon submission of a signed **Patient Authorization & Proxy Release Letter** along with IDs of both patient and proxy.
4. **Legal Heirs:** In the event of a deceased patient, upon presentation of the official Death Certificate, legal heir certificate, and requester photo ID.
5. **Statutory Legal Authorities:** Official court subpoenas, law enforcement requests signed by a competent magistrate, or statutory public health authorities.

6. Record Retention Policies

SmartCare Multispeciality Hospital retains clinical records in compliance with national statutory medical guidelines:

- **Adult Inpatient & Surgical Records:** Maintained for a minimum of **10 years** from the date of discharge.
- **Pediatric Records:** Maintained until the patient attains **25 years of age** (7 years past majority).
- **Outpatient Records & Diagnostic Reports:** Maintained in digital EMR archives for a minimum of **5 years**.
- **Medico-Legal Case (MLC) Records:** Maintained permanently or until final resolution of all court proceedings.

7. Administrative Correction of Demographic Errors

If a patient discovers an inadvertent error in their demographic data (e.g., misspelled name, wrong date of birth, or incorrect address):

- **Submission:** Submit a **Demographic Correction Request Form** at the MRD Desk or Registration Desk.
- **Proof Required:** Supporting Government photo ID (Aadhaar, Passport, or Birth Certificate) establishing the correct spelling or date.
- **Clinical Integrity Rule:** Medical notes, clinical observations, diagnostic findings, and doctor opinions **cannot** be altered retroactively. Factual administrative errors are corrected by appending an official administrative addendum signed by the Medical Superintendent.

8. AI Interpretation Boundary & Clinical Disclaimer

AI CLINICAL LIMITATION NOTICE:

*The SmartCare AI Assistant and hospital customer care executives can assist you in finding your reports, retrieving reference intervals, and explaining general medical definitions. **Neither the AI nor administrative staff are authorized to provide a medical diagnosis or alter treatments based on your reports.** Always schedule an appointment with your treating doctor to interpret diagnostic results in the context of your physical health.*

9. RAG Knowledge Search & Question Triggers

- **Trigger Queries:** "How do I get my discharge summary?", "Can I download my lab reports online?", "How do I get copies of my medical records?", "Can my son collect my reports?", "How do I correct my name on my hospital bill?", "Where is the medical records department?", "Can I get a copy of my CT scan CD?", "How long are medical records kept?"
- **Standardized Fact Base:** Reports available on online portal, app, and WhatsApp. Physical copies available at MRD (Basement 1, Mon–Sat 9 AM – 5 PM). Identity proof mandatory. Records retained for minimum 10 years.

10. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs)

Q1: Where is the Medical Records Department (MRD) located?

A: The Medical Records Department is located on Basement Level 1 in the Administrative Wing, open Monday through Saturday from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM.

Q2: How can I access my lab reports on my phone?

A: You can download your reports from the SmartCare Patient Portal, through our SmartCare Mobile App, or via the secure PDF link sent to your registered WhatsApp number upon report completion.

Q3: Can my spouse or child collect my printed medical records?

A: Yes, provided they present their government photo ID along with a signed authorization letter from you and your original discharge/sample receipt slip.

Q4: How long does it take to obtain a certified copy of an inpatient hospital record?

A: Standard certified indoor record requests take **24 to 72 business hours** to retrieve, review, photocopy, and stamp from our central digital and physical archives.

Q5: Is there a fee for obtaining copies of medical records?

A: Digital downloads through the patient portal are 100% free. Certified physical copies carry a nominal administrative processing fee (■50 for discharge summaries; ■2 per page for comprehensive indoor case sheets).

Q6: Can I get my MRI or CT scan images on a CD/DVD?

A: Yes. You can request a digital DICOM disc of your imaging studies from the Radiology Reception on Basement Level 1. A nominal disc generation fee of ■150 applies.

Q7: What should I do if my name is misspelled on my discharge summary?

A: Bring your original discharge summary and your government photo ID (Aadhaar or Passport) to the MRD Desk on Basement Level 1. The staff will verify the document and issue an official corrected addendum.

Q8: Can my doctor's clinical notes be changed if I disagree with what was written?

A: Clinical observations, medical diagnoses, and doctor opinions entered by the physician are legal medical records and cannot be altered or erased. If you believe an error exists, you may submit a formal letter of clarification to the Medical Superintendent.

Q9: How long does SmartCare retain medical records?

A: Inpatient medical records are retained for a minimum of 10 years. Pediatric records are maintained until the child turns 25. Diagnostic laboratory results are archived digitally for at least 5 years.

Q10: Can an insurance company request my medical records directly from the hospital?

A: SmartCare will share records with your insurance company only if you have signed a cashless pre-authorization agreement or a medical release authorization form authorizing the hospital to do so.

Q11: How do I get my medical records if I live in another city or country?

A: You can submit an online record request through the SmartCare Patient Portal, complete digital identity verification, and receive certified encrypted PDF files via email.

Q12: Can I get a duplicate copy of my discharge summary if I lost the original?

A: Yes. You can download and print it directly from the SmartCare Patient Portal at any time, or request an official stamped duplicate from the MRD Desk by presenting your government photo ID.

Q13: What happens to medical records in medico-legal cases (MLC)?

A: MLC records (e.g., road traffic accidents, assaults, unnatural injuries) are maintained under high-security custody permanently and can only be released upon judicial order, police requisition, or authorized court subpoena.

Q14: Are my medical records safe from unauthorized access or cyber attacks?

A: Yes. SmartCare employs high-grade end-to-end data encryption, multi-factor authentication, firewalls, and role-based access logs compliant with national healthcare cybersecurity standards.

Q15: Can a lawyer request my medical records without my consent?

A: No. A lawyer cannot obtain your medical records without your signed written consent, unless accompanied by an official court order issued by a competent magistrate.

Q16: How can I obtain a medical certificate for sick leave or fitness?

A: Medical leave certificates must be issued and signed directly by your treating consultant during an outpatient consultation or upon discharge. The MRD does not issue medical leave certificates independently.

Q17: Can I view my doctor's operative notes from my surgery?

A: Yes. A detailed summary of the surgical operation is incorporated into your final discharge summary. Full operative sheets can be requested through the MRD.

Q18: What is a UHID and how does it connect to my medical records?

A: Your Unique Hospital Identification (UHID) is your lifetime medical identifier at SmartCare. All your consultations, blood tests, radiology scans, surgeries, and prescriptions across all departments are permanently indexed under this single number.

Q19: Can I get copies of medical records for a deceased relative?

A: Yes. Legal heirs may request records by submitting the deceased patient's death certificate, a legal heir certificate or family relationship document, and the applicant's photo ID.

Q20: Can I review my biopsy or histopathology report online?

A: Yes. Once authorized by the consultant pathologist (typically 4 to 7 business days after tissue submission), biopsy reports are uploaded to the SmartCare Patient Portal.

Q21: What should I do if my doctor needs my records from a previous hospital?

A: Bring all past medical records, discharge summaries, imaging films, and recent lab reports to your appointment. Your SmartCare doctor will review them and scan key summaries into your SmartCare digital file.

Q22: Can I delete my medical history from the hospital database?

A: No. Under medical council guidelines and statutory healthcare regulations, hospitals are legally required to maintain an accurate, tamper-proof record of all medical treatments and consultations.

Q23: Are test results discussed over the phone by hospital staff?

A: To protect patient confidentiality and avoid clinical misinterpretation, staff will not read detailed diagnostic results over the phone. Patients should review authorized reports on the secure portal or consult their physician.

Q24: What should I do if I forget my SmartCare portal password?

A: Click "Forgot Password" on the login screen. You will be prompted to enter your registered mobile number or UHID, and an OTP will be sent to reset your credentials.

Q25: Can the SmartCare AI Assistant tell me if I have cancer based on my lab report?

A: No. The AI assistant can explain the meaning of medical terms and help you find your report, but it is not authorized or clinically capable of diagnosing illnesses. You must review your report with your treating specialist.

11. Official Contact Directory

- **Medical Records Department (MRD):** Basement Level 1, Administrative Wing
- **Direct Phone:** +91-40-6999-5577 / +91-40-6999-5578
- **Email:** mrd@smartcarehospital-demo.org / records@smartcarehospital-demo.org
- **Operating Hours:** Monday through Saturday, 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM